

THE
COMMUNICATIONS
AND ELECTRONICS BRANCH

95 CRAFTSMAN BOULEVARD
CFB KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4



BRANCHE
DES COMMUNICATIONS
ET DE L'ÉLECTRONIQUE

95 CRAFTSMAN BOULEVARD
BFC KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4

1180-5 (Br Adj)

December 2024

Distribution List

SENATE MEETING
RECORD OF DISCUSSION –
THURSDAY, 24 OCTOBER 2024

RECORD OF ATTENDANCE

POSITION / APPOINTMENT	RANK & NAME
Co-Chair / Colonel Commandant	Brigadier-General Martin Girard (Retired)
Co-Chair / Branch Leader	Major-General Dave Yarker
Member / Previous Branch Leader	Brigadier-General James Lambert (Retired)
Member / Previous Colonel Commandant	Brigadier-General Josée Robidoux (Retired)
Member / Branch Advisor	Colonel Steeve Lavoie
Member / Branch Chief	Chief Warrant Officer Renay Groves
Member / Previous Branch Chief	Chief Warrant Officer Alex Arndt
Member / Association President	Major-General John Leech (Retired)
Member / Foundation President	Lieutenant-Colonel Scott Mclean (Retired) (regrets)
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Pascal Godbout (regrets)
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Francois Robichaud (regrets)
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Walter Norquay
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Mark Parsons
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Justin Thibert (regrets)
Member / CO C&E Museum	Lieutenant-Colonel Geneviève Audet

Guest / OC Museum	Major Scott Oikle
Guest / Museum Rep	Mr. Rory Cory
Guest / D RCCS Res	LCol Lisa Smid
Guest / Cyber Comd CWO	CWO Peter Holub
Secretariat / Branch Adjutant	Major Gregory McDonald

OPENING REMARKS

1. The new Colonel Commandant expressed gratitude for being appointed. The previous Colonel Commandant then provided a welcome to the new Colonel Commandant. The Branch Leader welcomed the Colonel Commandant, thanked the previous Colonel Commandant, and provided opening remarks.

REVIEW OF PREVIOUS SENATE MEETING

2. The Colonel Commandant asked if there were any changes to be made to the previous Record of Discussion. As there were no objections, the previous Record of Discussion was approved, but a minor typo was noticed and required updating.

Action

1. Branch Office to update the Record of Discussion to reflect the noted adjustment.

OLD BUSINESS I – BRANCH COMMS PLAN UPDATE

3. The communications plan update was provided by the Branch Advisor regarding updates to the communications plan, mentioning the work still required and that work has been slow. It was identified that one questionnaire for all Family members will be developed. It was further identified that the Branch Office was asked at the BAC to develop a Branch Office Fund Communique which was provided for review. The previous Colonel Commandant indicated that they would like to review the questionnaire prior to Branch Leader's review. The Branch Leader identified two parts to improve upon the questionnaire. First, there are plenty of ways to get feedback such as listening sessions. Other channels of communication should be considered prior to moving ahead with the questionnaire. Second, at the next update to senate, concrete steps are required for what will be done with the answers.

Action

1. Branch Office to complete the questionnaire and provide it to the previous Colonel Commandant for review.

2. Branch Office to develop a plan for managing the answers to the questionnaire.

OLD BUSINESS II – 125TH ANNIVERSARY PLANNING

4. Planning for the 125th anniversary, slated for 2028, was discussed. Collaboration with external partners, such as retired Brigadier Generals and other associations, was emphasized for effective execution. Coordination will be done within the Branch but requires support of the whole community. It was suggested that the Branch looks for support from Brian Briere. Also, the Branch Office will look at lessons learned for 100th Anniversary of the RCAF. It was reminded that the Branch needs to request Princess Anne's participation for the 125th Anniversary. The conversation then turned to vacant Class A Branch Affairs Officer position. It was identified that ADM(DSG) pays the reserve salary for the position. Further, discussion on filling the position ensued. The position will be filled through competition, not selection. Discussion then moved to establishing the 125th planning committee. The Colonel Commandant will look to the retired community for a co-chair. It was highlighted that with a reduction in funding and capacity to support these types of events, we will need support from the non-serving members. The Moncton event was discussed, noting that it only succeeded due to the large contribution from Honorary Colonels. The Colonel Commandant and the Branch Office identified that they could look for archives from the 2003 and 2013 celebrations. Archives of particular interest were the documents for security, which were exemplary. LCol Smid identified that they would reach out to the Honorary Colonel in NB. It was also mentioned that Honorary Colonel experience in the Signal Regiments is rather new and may have to offset experience with passion in seeing a successful 125th. The Branch Office was tasked to look at things we could do now to be prepared once we have the co-chairs ready to go. The previous Branch Leader mentioned there is a detailed After-Action Review from 2013 that should be reviewed. The previous Branch Leader mentioned that they were consumed with the 110th Anniversary for 3 months while they were CFSCE Commandant and that a significant number of CFSCE personnel had to be tasked full-time. Further, they noted that the C&E Branch took the brunt of work for 110th celebration with other organizations/branches leveraging our work to benefit from the Princess Royal's visit which is as it should be. It was decided that the 125th Anniversary will remain on the agenda for the C&E Senate and other meetings while identifying that a draft plan and draft roadmap to an oversight committee must be prepared by the Branch Office for the next Senate meeting.

CLARIFICATION POST-MEETING: The Branch has two permanent military officer positions on its establishment. One is the Regular Force Major IM OFFICER (CELE) position, C&E Branch Adjutant. The other is a Class A Reserve LCol Any Trade position, C&E Branch Affairs Officer. The Branch Affairs Officer position was a Major position but recently had an Establishment Change Request approved to change the position to LCol, with the understanding that the incumbent would have a dual role of planning the 125th Anniversary and advising both the C&E Branch Executive and Director RCCS on Reserve issues.

Action

1. Branch Office to look for archives of previous milestone anniversaries.

2. Branch Office to investigate what preparations can be done now, prior to identifying co-chairs for 125th Anniversary Planning Committee
3. Branch Office to draft 125th Anniversary Plan by next Senate meeting
4. Branch Office to draft Roadmap to 125th Anniversary Planning Committee by next Senate meeting

OLD BUSINESS III – BRANCH OFFICE REPORT

5. The Branch Adjutant provided a Branch Office Report including eSports (Capture the Flag), staffing and finances. The Branch Office was tasked with securing a two-minute video of Capture the Flag. Discussion ensued about the Branch Office Fund Pamphlet to clarify if it was replacing other documents. The Branch Office was tasked with distributing the pamphlet to the Senate membership for review prior to seeking approval from the Branch Leader. During the honours and recognition update, it was identified that a key metrics for the communications plan include the number of applications for Educational Bursaries (only one this year), and H&R nominations such as the Heritage Award. The Home Station Commandant identified that they would support the development of Branch Office Fund Pamphlet with their Publication Development section. Discussion then turned to the Branch Communications Plan where it was identified that the approval of the pamphlet should not wait for the finalization of the plan but must be aligned to it. The communications plan must also include the whole Branch Family. It was also identified that based on the low number of nominations for H&R, we can conclude that we are not giving Branch members what they want.

Action

1. Branch Office to secure two-minute video of Capture the Flag.
2. Branch Office to distribute Branch Office Fund Pamphlet to Senate membership for review.

OLD BUSINESS IV – MUSEUM REPORT

6. After a quick introduction by the Cmdt, OC Museum provided a presentation on attendance and funding. Mr Cory then presented the budget for fiscal year 25/26 and the potential for museum expansion. Mr Cory identified that on 22 June 2025, the museum is looking at hosting a large event. It was discussed that it would be good to have a soft plan for the 125th Anniversary for a “dry run” on 22 June, if possible. Engagement with partners was identified as a critical step towards success. Discussion ensued on how the museum is engaging the Intelligence Branch to potentially include them in future plans. Questions were raised about funding support from different levels of government. It was identified that expansion would provide these funding opportunities. Different options for fundraising were then explored before transitioning to upcoming events at the museum.

Action

1. Museum to investigate different fundraising structures for Unit Skylights.

2. Museum to investigate expanding Veterans' Coffee to include virtual attendance.
3. Museum to invite Branch Leadership for museum events, including 22 June 2025 event.

NEW BUSINESS I – FOUNDATION REPORT

7. Due to a scheduling conflict, the C&E Foundation was not available for the C&E Senate meeting. A presentation was provided for inclusion in the C&E Senate slide deck.

NEW BUSINESS II – ASSOCIATION REPORT

8. The President of the C&E Association provided a report across heritage efforts, attendance at events, business planning and various services offered to members. The Association provided a reminder that the Association has a mandate to assist members in distress and can match the Branch's contributions. The Association identified that they are investigating the possibility of opening chapters. Discussion ensued on serving members ability to participate. The Association indicated that they are open to increasing participation but would need to establish a framework if units were looking at having specific representation within the Association. It was also decided that the Branch Office should provide clarification on areas of responsibility to ensure broad participation is enabled across the Branch Family.

Action

1. Branch Office to develop an engagement strategy for units to maintain communications and awareness of Association activities.

NEW BUSINESS III – MUSEUM GOVERNANCE

9. The Senate discussed the ideas around museum governance to ensure the Museum can operate and innovate with support from the Branch Family. It was also reinforced that the Branch Family has an influencing role, not authoritative role. After discussions, it was decided that the Museum can capture the Branch Family's feedback through inclusion in the Museum Feasibility Study. The Branch Office was tasked with collating input from the Branch Family to be included in the feasibility study which can identify areas that the Branch Family would like to be consulted on. The previous Branch CWO identified that the principle of the museum being self supported by the Foundation could be at risk if we are looking to Branch members to financially support a museum expansion through P070 contributions.

Action

1. Museum to produce Feasibility Study.
2. Museum to identify deadline for Branch Family feedback for the Feasibility Study.
3. Branch Office to collect feedback from the Branch Family which will be included in the Museum's expansion feasibility study.

OPEN FORUM / CLOSING REMARKS

10. The previous Colonel Commandant requested that BGen (ret'd) Kevin O'Keefe be invited to the next C&E Senate meeting to provide an update on the Book of Remembrance. The Branch Leader and Colonel Commandant thanked everyone for participating, thanked the previous Branch CWO for their tireless work with the Branch, and welcomed the new Branch CWO.

Action

1. Branch Office to invite BGen (ret'd) O'Keefe to the next C&E Senate meeting for an update on the Book of Remembrance



Brigadier-General Martin Girard, OMM, MSM, CD (Retired)
Branch Colonel Commandant

YARKER,
DAVID 516

Digitally signed by
YARKER, DAVID 516
Date: 2025.01.29
16:41:42 -05'00'

Major-General Dave Yarker, CD
Branch Leader